

Hypothesis Testing

1: What is a null hypothesis (H_0) and why is it important in hypothesis testing?

The null hypothesis (H_0) is a statement that assumes no significant difference, effect, or relationship exists in a population. It is important because it provides a baseline for statistical testing and helps researchers make objective decisions based on sample data.

2: What does the significance level (α) represent in hypothesis testing?

The significance level (α) is the maximum probability of making a Type I error, i.e., rejecting a true null hypothesis. It serves as the threshold for deciding whether the evidence against H_0 is strong enough to reject it. Common values are 0.05, 0.01, and 0.10.

3: Differentiate between Type I and Type II errors.

A Type I error occurs when a true null hypothesis is rejected (false positive), while a Type II error occurs when a false null hypothesis is not rejected (false negative). The probability of a Type I error is denoted by α , and the probability of a Type II error is denoted by β .

4: Explain the difference between a one-tailed and two-tailed test. Give an example of each.

A one-tailed test is used when the alternative hypothesis specifies a direction (e.g., $\mu > 100$ or $\mu < 100$). A two-tailed test is used when the alternative hypothesis only states that the parameter is different ($\mu \neq \text{value}$). For example, testing whether sales increased is a one-tailed test, while testing whether sales changed is a two-tailed test.

5: A company claims that the average time to resolve a customer complaint is 10 minutes. A random sample of 9 complaints gives an average time of 12 minutes and a standard deviation of 3 minutes. At $\alpha = 0.05$, test the claim.

Hypothesis Testing (One-Sample t-Test)

The company claims that the average complaint resolution time is 10 minutes.

$H_0 : \mu=10$

(This is a two-tailed test because we are testing whether the true mean differs from 10.)

Step 2: Given Data

- Sample size: $n=9$
- Sample mean: $\bar{x}=12$
- Sample standard deviation: $s=3$
- Population mean claimed: $\mu_0=10$
- Significance level: $\alpha=0.05$

Since:

- Population standard deviation is unknown.
- Sample size is small ($n<30$).

We use a t-test.

Step 3: Calculate the Test Statistic

The t-statistic is:

$$t = (\bar{x} - \mu_0) / (s / \sqrt{n})$$

Substitute the values:

$$t = (12 - 10) / (3 / \sqrt{9}) = 2$$

Step 4: Determine the Critical Value

Degrees of freedom:

$$df = n - 1 = 9 - 1 = 8$$

For a two-tailed test at $\alpha = 0.05$:

$$T_{0.025, 8} = \pm 2.306$$

Step 5: Decision Rule

- Reject H_0 if $|t| > 2.306$
- Fail to reject H_0 if $|t| \leq 2.306$

Our calculated value:

$$|t| = 2$$

Since:

$$2 < 2.306$$

we fail to reject H_0

At the 5% significance level, there is insufficient evidence to conclude that the average complaint resolution time differs from 10 minutes.

Final Answer

- Test statistic: $t = 2.00$
- Critical value: ± 2.306
- Decision: Fail to reject H_0

Conclusion: The sample does not provide enough evidence to reject the company's claim that the average complaint resolution time is 10 minutes at $\alpha = 0.05$.

6: When should you use a Z-test instead of a t-test?

A Z-test is used when the population standard deviation (σ) is known and/or the sample size is large ($n \geq 30$). A t-test is used when σ is unknown, especially for small samples ($n < 30$). The Z-test uses the normal distribution, while the t-test uses the t-distribution.

7: The productivity of 6 employees was measured before and after a training program. At $\alpha = 0.05$, test if the training improved productivity.

Paired t-Test (Before vs After Training)

Let $d = \text{After} - \text{Before}$

$$H_0: \mu_d = 0$$

(No improvement in productivity)

H1: $\mu_d > 0$

(Productivity improved after training)

This is a right-tailed paired t-test.

Step 2: Calculate the Differences

Employee	Before	After	Difference (d)
1	50	55	5
2	60	65	5
3	58	59	1
4	55	58	3
5	62	63	1
6	56	59	3

$d = [5, 5, 1, 3, 1, 3]$

$$\bar{d} = 5 + 5 + 1 + 3 + 1 + 3 / 6 = 18 / 6 = 3$$

d	$d - \bar{d}$	$(d - \bar{d})^2$
5	2	4
5	2	4
1	-2	4
3	0	0
1	-2	4
3	0	0

$$\sum (d - \bar{d})^2 = 16$$

Sample variance:

$$s^2 = 16 / (6 - 1) = 3.2$$

$$t = \bar{d} / (s / \sqrt{n})$$

$$t \approx 4.11$$

Degrees of freedom:

$$df = n - 1 = 6 - 1 = 5$$

For a one-tailed test at $\alpha = 0.05$:

$t_{0.05,5}=2.015$

- Calculated $t=4.11$
- Critical $t=2.015$

Since

$4.11 > 2.015$

Reject H_0

Conclusion

At the 5% significance level, there is sufficient evidence to conclude that the training program significantly improved employee productivity.

Final Answer

- Mean difference = 3
- Standard deviation of differences = 1.789
- Test statistic = 4.11
- Critical value = 2.015

Reject H_0

The training program improved productivity

8: A company wants to test if product preference is independent of gender. At $\alpha = 0.05$, test independence

We want to test whether product preference is independent of gender.

State the Hypotheses

H_0 : Gender and product preference are independent

H_1 : Gender and product preference are not independent

Significance level:

$\alpha=0.05$

Observed Frequencies (O)

Gender	Product A	Product B	Total
Male	30	20	50
Female	10	40	50
Total	40	60	100

Expected Frequencies (E)

Formula:

$$E = (\text{Row Total})(\text{Column Total}) / \text{Grand Total}$$

Male, Product A

$$E_{11} = 50 \times 40 / 100 = 20$$

Male, Product B

$$E_{12} = 50 \times 60 / 100 = 30$$

Female, Product A

$$E_{21} = 50 \times 40 / 100 = 20$$

Female, Product B

$$E_{22} = 50 \times 60 / 100 = 30$$

Expected table:

Gender	Product A	Product B
Male	20	30
Female	20	30

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Formula:

$$\chi^2 = \sum (O - E)^2 / E$$

Cell	O	E	(O-E)^2/E
Male-A	30	20	5
Male-B	20	30	3.333
Female-A	10	20	5
Female-B	40	30	3.333
$\chi^2 = 5 + 3.333 + 5 + 3.333 = 16.67$			

Critical Value

Degrees of freedom:

$$df = (r-1)(c-1) = (2-1)(2-1) = 1$$

At $\alpha = 0.05$ and $df = 1$:

$$\chi^2_{\text{critical}} = 3.841$$

Decision

- Calculated $\chi^2 = 16.67$
- Critical $\chi^2 = 3.841$

Since:

$$16.67 > 3.841$$

Reject H_0

Conclusion

There is sufficient evidence at the 5% significance level to conclude that product preference is not independent of gender.

Final Answer

$$\chi^2 = 16.67$$

Reject H_0

Conclusion: Gender and product preference are significantly associated. Product preference depends on gender.